

# Burners [?] OSE Conversions

In the spirit of *The White Hack*, *The Black Hack*, and *The Black Sword Hack*, this is **the Burners Hack**. Use the original roleplaying game — through the lens of how Old-School Essentials has cleaned it up — **unless Burners says otherwise**. Modules, treasure types, morale, reaction, turns, and the rest come in as written; this page is the routing table for where the Hack replaces or reframes a piece. Every conversion also follows Burners Principles.

**Clocks.** OSE turns and rounds are Burners turns and rounds. Durations and light burn as written (torch 6 Turns / one hour-cycle, lantern 24 per flask; candles on Burners Equipment). Wandering monsters: Burners Referee Guide#Turn Tracker — always 1-in-6; roll on even turns and again when noise, dark, or wounds fire. OSE’s plain check every other turn is the time signature. OSE’s “rest one turn every hour or –1 to hit” is not used; Burners recovers HP with an Burners Adventure Game#Wounds|Hour Rest (a full quiet cycle, food and water, unwounded) instead.

**Default (keep as written).** Morale (2–12 on 2d6); reaction (2d6 — add **Heart** if a Burner leads the parley); number appearing; Treasure Type and coin values; movement as relative speed. Treasure XP and shares: Burners Experience (claimed haul, magic 0 XP, monster parts not XP, Eldar column).

## XP Awards

Burners uses OSE monster numbers on its own level table (see Burners Experience). Port treasure types and coin values as written; award treasure XP when the haul is **claimed**. Shares and part-out: Burners Experience. Eldar use the double-XP column.

| Source               | Award                                    |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Monster overcome     | Printed OSE XP, or HD chart below        |
| Coins, gems, jewelry | 1 XP per 1 gp when claimed               |
| Goods, art           | 1 XP per 1 gp when claimed (Ref sets gp) |
| Magic items          | 0 XP — the item is the reward            |
| Monster parts        | gp or kit when claimed — <b>0 XP</b>     |

Level when you next sleep somewhere safe after your XP crosses a tier (see Burners Experience).

## Monster XP by Hit Dice (OSE)

| HD      | XP  | HD    | XP      |
|---------|-----|-------|---------|
| under 1 | 5   | 7     | 950     |
| 1       | 10  | 8     | 1,900   |
| 2       | 20  | 9–10  | 2,750   |
| 3       | 60  | 11–12 | 4,500   |
| 4       | 125 | 13–16 | 6,000   |
| 5       | 250 | 17–20 | 8,500   |
| 6       | 500 | 21+   | 10,000+ |

For fractional or special HD, **prefer the monster's printed XP** or the full OSE Awarding XP table (base + bonus per \* ability). This short chart is a coarse shortcut — e.g. HD 3 reads **60** here, but an OSE Wight (3\*) is **50 XP**.

**Converting a module hoard.** Roll or place treasure as OSE directs. Coins, gems, jewelry, goods, and art pay **1 XP per gp** when **claimed** — left behind grants nothing until claimed; the Referee sets each find's gp once (now or later). Magic items pay **0 XP**; the item is the reward. Carcass parts (hide, tusks, ivory) may sell or be useful kit — **0 XP** ([[Burners Experience#Part out]]). Delving retainers: full share if Mustering, half if not (see [[Burners Muster]]). Full procedure: [[Burners Experience]].

## Monsters

### The Stat Line

| OSE                         | Burners                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>HD</b>                   | Level, 1:1. <b>Monster Stack</b> = $2 \times \text{HD}$ playing cards (face-down closed / face-up open).                                                                                                                             |
| <b>XP</b>                   | Award when overcome — <b>XP by HD</b> from the table in <i>XP Awards</i> (a 1 HD skeleton = 10; HD 2 = 20). Use the module's printed award if given.                                                                                 |
| <b>AC</b>                   | Hint for the <b>face mix</b> only — soft kit → some face-down; shell/plate → mostly face-down; naked/sushi → all face-up. Suggest a <b>right tool</b> fiction (poleax, slicing, silver...) players may claim for the extra Fuel die. |
| <b>Damage die</b>           | Quote weight for Referee speed attacks (d6 → quote 3, etc.) — see [[Burners Referee Guide#Monsters at speed (preferred Referee mode)]].                                                                                              |
| <b>Saves</b>                | Deleted — route the <i>ability</i> through the Defend Router                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Morale</b>               | As written                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>THAC0 / attack bonus</b> | Deleted — there are no to-hit rolls                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

### 2 × HD Monster Stack (face mix)

See [[Burners Principles#Armor soaks; monsters use Monster Stacks]] and [[Burners Referee Guide#Monsters at speed (preferred Referee mode)]]. **Monsters do not use PC Armor Class.**

#### Referee speed (preferred):

1. Deal  $2 \times \text{HD}$  playing cards onto the table.
2. Paint the **face mix**: naked/sushi/no kit → **all face-up**; soft kit (leather, shield) → **some face-down**; mail/heavier → more face-down; true shell/plate/scales → **mostly or all face-down**. Soft armor **adds face-downs into the mix** — not a flat soak outside the budget.
3. Hard shell/plate / sushi often suggests a **right tool** (poleax, slicing, silver...) — claiming it lets a player burn **one extra Fuel** into the blow. Hits are always  $\lceil \text{damage} \div 5 \rceil$ ; closed → **-1**, always, while any face-down remains.

Do **not** invent a tiny soak “just because the book had AC.” AC 1–2 as flat damage reduction was a **Referee math tax** — players never changed tactics for it.

Worked: **orc in leather** HD 1 → **1 down / 1 up**. **Wolf / naked tough** → **all face-up** ( $2 \times \text{HD}$ ). **Wet Devil** HD 8 → **16 face-up**. **Giant crab** HD 3 → **6 face-down**; poleax as right tool. **Knight in plate** → heavy face-down in  $2 \times \text{HD}$ ; magic or pollaxe as right tool. **Dragon** → mostly face-down; name fire / soft underbelly / etc.

When a PC **loots** a suit of armor off a foe, that kit becomes ordinary Burners AC for the wearer — the monster’s face-down cards were the table paint, not PC AC.

## The Damage Die → quotes (and optional full-dice)

Preferred Referee play is **Heat-only pool + free quoted attacks** — no free monster Defend — [[Burners Referee Guide#Monsters at speed (preferred Referee mode)]]]. The OSE damage die sets **quote weight** (and optional full-dice ports when you run a foe like a PC). It is **not** a second Initiative pile.

### Quote from the die (preferred):

| OSE damage die | Quote (rough)     |
|----------------|-------------------|
| 1d4            | 2                 |
| 1d6            | 2 or 3            |
| 1d8            | 4                 |
| 1d10           | 5                 |
| 1d12, 2d6+     | 5 (or two quotes) |

**Optional full-dice ports** (named foes you want to burn Fuel like a Burner): treat the damage die as weapon slots for blow weight — 1d4 → 1 slot, 1d6 → 2, 1d8 → 3, etc. — and roll a Fuel pool. See [[Burners Arms and Armor]]. Most nights, don’t.

**Natural attacks** are quotes (or weapon slots on a full-dice port), not Initiative dice.

**Initiative** is the count of **Heat** dice showing 3 or 4 (preferred). A hotter room tends to act earlier. Optional full-dice foes may add their own pool — label that choice at the table. Fiction tempo still holds:

- **Shambling** (*the sluggish dead, oozes, rooted things*): **acts last**, regardless of dice.
- **A living spear** (*cobra, ambush-hunter*): acts at the **top of the order** regardless of dice count.

**Charge** (*a beast closing at a run — where OSE pounce/leap riders convert*): a situational bump the Referee adds to the quote — as any situation can bump a blow (see [[Burners Adventure Game]]). **Shambling** things never get it.

**Receive a Charge** (*maneuver — a braced longer weapon, and you must see it coming*): your thrust strikes **first**, before the rush lands, and the charger’s rush adds to *your* blow instead. If it survives and presses in, its attack resolves as normal.

**Multi-attack routines** (claw/claw/bite): the Referee sets how many **quotes** the creature throws (a wolf bites once, a bear claws twice, a hydra strikes per head), each defended separately. Spread them across several characters, or land them all on one.

**Spellcasting monsters**: convert their list through the Spells section, or skip the list and quote each casting as a blow or a telegraph. A dragon does not need a spellbook; it needs a Breath telegraph and two good tricks.

## The Defend Router

An OSE save is a pointer to a Burners subsystem — see [[Burners Principles#Route, don’t reinvent]] and [[Burners Principles#Granular defense, not binary save]]. 2d6 + **the fitting Approach** against the Referee’s Cost handles most hazards (see *Approach Roll* in [[Burners Adventure Game]]). Hostile magic uses Fuel Defend against the caster’s cast total (see [[Burners Sorcerie]]). Ask what the save protects, then route it:

| OSE says | Burners does                                                              |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|          | <b>Area effect</b> — see [[Burners Principles#Telegraph the unwinnable]]. |

| OSE says                                          | Burners does                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Save<br>vs. <b>Breath</b>                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Save<br>vs. <b>Poison</b><br>(or die)             | <b>Defend</b> (Craft) to avoid; <b>lingering Cost</b> once it lands. See [[Burners Principles#No instant death]].                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Save<br>vs. <b>Paralysis</b>                      | <b>Defend</b> (Craft or Sword) at the touch; fall short and you <b>stiffen</b> for a stated clock (ghoul-chill, 2d6 rounds) — recoverable, not permanent.                                                                                                                                         |
| Save<br>vs. <b>Petrify</b>                        | <b>Counting doom</b> : repeated <b>Defends</b> (Craft or Sword), each miss a step toward stone; it recovers. Averting your eyes is the counterplay, at the price of fighting blind.                                                                                                               |
| Save<br>vs. <b>Spells / Wands / Rods / Staves</b> | Fuel <b>Defend</b> vs <b>cast total</b> ; roll initiative OOC. See [[Burners Principles#Granular defense, not binary save]] and [[Burners Principles#Harm and effect are separate lanes]]. <b>Ward</b> : adjacent Sorcerer burns ≤ Sorcerie Level Fuel to cut the attack, then each ally Defends. |
| Save<br>vs. <b>Death effects</b>                  | <b>Shock Check</b> and <b>Wounds</b> , then post-fight help + Craft survival — see [[Burners Principles#No instant death]] and [[Burners Adventure Game#Wounds]].                                                                                                                                 |

**Which Approach?** Craft to dodge a dart, pit, or poison; Sword to force a door, hold your feet, or stay conscious; Heart against fear and horror; Sorcerie to dredge up what you know against the uncanny. The player may argue for another Approach if the fiction fits. When in doubt: Craft to avoid, Sword to endure.

## Deriving a Score (when a module needs a raw number)

Burners has no ability scores on the sheet. On the rare occasion a module wants an actual number — an opposed feat of might, a stat-keyed gate — derive one on the fly as **10 + the fitting Approach level**:

| Old score | Approach |
|-----------|----------|
| STR       | Sword    |
| DEX, CON  | Craft    |
| WIS, CHA  | Heart    |
| INT       | Sorcerie |

So a Sword 3 stands at an effective 13, a Craft 2 at 12. This is a fallback for the odd direct comparison, not a number to track — most endurance routes through a **Defend** (2d6 + **Approach**) and most contests are a **Pay** or **Deal** roll the same way.

## “Magic Weapons to Hit” → armor + right tool

See [[Burners Principles#Armor soaks; monsters use Monster Stacks]].

| OSE says               | Burners                                                                                                                   | The feel                                                                                     |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Silver or magic to hit | Heavy <b>face-down</b> in the 2 × HD mix; players may claim silver/magic as the right tool (one extra Fuel into the blow) | <i>Resistant</i> . Everyone eats the −1 while face-down stands; the smart play is the claim. |
| +1 or better to hit    | Same; right-tool fiction = legendary blade or stated weakness                                                             | <i>Unearthly</i> . Mortal steel is folklore; the right edge makes it mortal.                 |

| OSE says               | Burners                                                                                   | The feel                                                    |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| +2/+3 or better to hit | Same — the right tool may need <i>discovery</i> , or a fiction gate ( <i>phylactery</i> ) | <i>A puzzle wearing a stack</i> . Not a bigger soak number. |

The **right tool** is a **player claim** (fiction + one extra Fuel burned into the blow), not a Ref auto-switch — see [[Burners Principles#Armor soaks; monsters use Monster Stacks]]. Same spirit as a Bane-forged weapon (see [[Burners Arms and Armor]]).

**Undead & energy drain** (OSE): **no levels lost**. Any of the Fallen that **wounds** you opens a **Fallen Wound**. Midnight / Purge: husks deepen by 1; drainers by 1d6 + 1d6 per OSE drain level (wight 2d6). Immediate Craft survival; die unclean → spawn; die from purge → no spawn. See [[Burners Burn Undead#Fallen Wounds]] and [[Burners Principles#No instant death]].

**Mobs vs. the unearthly**: see [[Burners Principles#Armor soaks; monsters use Monster Stacks]].

## Checks, Doors, and Skills

A module check splits two ways. A trained or skilled attempt — thief skills, foraging, listening at doors — becomes 2d6 + **fitting Approach vs. Heat**, quoted as a **Pay** (the world acts on you — shortfall is the cost) or a **Deal** (you act on it — shortfall is no purchase). A raw attribute check with no skill behind it — bend bars, leap a chasm, stare down a horror — is the same: 2d6 + Sword, Craft, or Heart vs the Referee’s Cost.

| OSE chance | Heat |
|------------|------|
| 5-in-6     | 6    |
| 4-in-6     | 7    |
| 3-in-6     | 8    |
| 2-in-6     | 9    |
| 1-in-6     | 10   |

Stuck doors, thief skills, foraging, listening at doors — all this table. A trained Approach shifts the odds; that is the point of being a Burner.

**Traps and environmental damage** — see [[Burners Principles#Pools, not fixed numbers]] (*Traps*). Average the module die to flat Damage; detect or eat.

**Worked in the margin — the OSE zombie** (AC 8 [11] · HD 2 (9hp) · 1 × weapon, 1d8 · Morale 12):

**Zombie**. HD 2 → **4 red** (AC 8 → no kit) · Heat dish for the side · **Shambling** — acts last · Morale 12 as written · **XP 20**. Quote fists as heavy (4).

Read straight off the printed block — 2 × HD cards (face mix), Heat, right-tool-if-any, tempo, Morale.

# Spells

Port OSE spells onto [[Burners Spells]] when a match exists; otherwise write a one-line effect in the same format (School L: ...).

- **Spell level = cast level SL.** Hand holds prepared cards; Arcana slot count sets hand size; drip rides in Arcana slots at full item cost. Sleep recovers up to caster Level cards (untap/burn/lasting); redraw or one-hour swap needs a readable source.
  - **Durations and ranges as written** — the clocks match.
  - **Casting (combat):** one Action; burn at least SL Fuel dice, roll them — cast total = sum of faces. Tap the card. On a Spark, Fuel it with one or more additional Fuel dice, up to SL, for extra effect; unfueled, it fades. May burn ready cards in the same Action to recast or copy.
  - **Casting (NPC / module caster):** roll at least **SL Fuel dice** for the cast total the same way. A hostile cast **rolls initiative** if no fight is underway.
  - **Defense and damage:** see [[Burners Principles#Granular defense, not binary save]] and [[Burners Principles#Harm and effect are separate lanes]]. Ignore OSE per-caster-level dice and fixed damage lines; overrun to HP 1:1. *Save for half* does not port.
  - **Scrolls** require a **Sorcerer** (or Journeyman + Canting for Canting) — single-use items, any form; not cards (see [[Burners Sorcerie]]).
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## Magic Items

Potions, rings, cursed items, and wondrous items port **as written** — they are fiction plus a rule, and the fiction is the value. **Magic items grant no XP**; the item is the reward (see *XP Awards*). Wands and staves that fit **Wizard Drip** ride in Arcana slots at full slot cost (costume drip 100 gp in town; enchanted drip is a find — see [[Burners Sorcerie]]); they do not add hand cards. Item powers run as magic items, or for a one-off keep charges as a simple budget.

### +n Arms, Shields, and Armor → Enchanted + Powers

Convert *+1 sword*, *+2 shield*, *+1 plate*, and so on per [[Burners Referee Magic Items]] — extra die, +n powers, Tuned / Bane / relic ladders, and the OSE power menus all live there. Trait for the extra die: [[Burners Adventure Game#Enchanted Arms and Armor]]. Keep Slots, AC, and size as the mundane piece.

Potions, rings, and wondrous items stay as written above. Do not raise AC or size for a plus.

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## Watchpoints

- **Lethality is comparable** — B/X at low levels is brutal and Burners characters are lean. Large mobs can spike past any defend; use swarm splitting and chokepoints.
  - **Foreshadowing is mechanical** — see [[Burners Principles#Heat is scene pressure]].
  - **Solo bosses** need enough face-down (and face-up) in  $2 \times \text{HD}$  to survive the party's first-round burst, or they die before their first telegraph.
  - **Don't double-count dread** — see [[Burners Principles#Heat is scene pressure]].
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*Read the stat block once, write it in the margin —  $2 \times \text{HD}$  cards (face mix), Heat, right-tool-if-any, XP by HD — route the saves through Defend, and run it.*